



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Ambrose Academy
School Website: <https://ambroseclassical.com>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Ambrose Academy (Manhattan, KS 66503) presents a clearly Christian, classical-leaning program with a strong emphasis on formation of virtue, wisdom, and a Christian worldview. Public materials emphasize Christ-centered discipleship, a theology-grounded curriculum, small class sizes, and active partnership with parents. The school demonstrates substantial alignment with classical education principles—especially in its stated goals, curriculum emphases (Latin, classic literature, theology, worldview, and a long historical timeline), and a governance/teacher formation approach that models virtue. The Pedagogy category shows partial alignment (the school highlights classical content and teacher training) but does not repeatedly and explicitly document core classical teaching modalities (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé, or explicit Great Books/Great Conversation practices) in the public materials currently available, which places Pedagogy in the "Somewhat Classical" range rather than fully Classical. The aggregate posture across all six categories lands squarely in CLASSICAL, with one category requiring further explicit articulation to reach full alignment.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL** Evidence highlights explicit Christian doctrine and formation aims (Christ-centered mission; statement of faith; theology woven through curriculum). Positive keywords (Christ, God, Scripture, theology, disciples) predominate; one negative signal from a contrasting description of secular modern education appears elsewhere in the broader classical discussion. Overall, the religious/metaphysical foundation is clearly oriented toward classical Christian formation.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL** The school foregrounds formation of virtue and wisdom, a telos-centered aim, and a Christ-centered formation framework. Positive keywords such as formation, virtue, wisdom, and a real pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty appear in its materials. There is little to no evidence of a primary workforce-or-work-readiness emphasis in these sources.
- **Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL** Curriculum emphases include Latin and classical languages, classic literature, philosophy, theology, worldview, and a historic timeline from creation to modernity; history is treated as a central, integrative discipline rather than mere "social studies." Positive keywords such as Latin, classic literature, philosophy, theology, worldview, and timeless historical framing are present. No strong negative signals about curriculum structure are evident in the public materials.
- **Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence shows a strong classical content focus and teacher training, plus small class size. However, explicit, repeated articulation of core classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning, memorization/narration, or firm Great Books/Great Conversation practices) is not consistently documented in the public

materials. This yields a partial alignment: foundational classical aims are present, but the pedagogy section could be more explicit about established classical methods.

- **Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL** The faculty is presented through concrete personnel (e.g., 2nd Grade Teacher with classical educator training) and a culture of mentorship and character formation. The staff are described as seasoned, trained in classical pedagogy, and as living exemplars of the school's ethos. This aligns with a Classical profile of teachers as living exemplars and the core of the school.
- **Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL** The school publicly emphasizes partnering with parents, parental formation, and open, ongoing parental involvement. Statements about co-teaching, parental primacy in formation, and invitations for families to engage align strongly with the classical model's emphasis on a robust parent-school partnership.

Overall aggregate classification: CLASSICAL The Ambrose Academy public materials demonstrate robust Classical Christian alignment across Religion/Metaphysics, Purpose/Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents/Community. Pedagogy is the lone area with a need for more explicit articulation of established classical teaching methods to move from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL in that category.

What would move the needle - Pedagogy: Explicitly publish and emphasize the use of Socratic seminars, scholé days, and narration/dictation as standard upper-elementary/secondary practices, and connect these methods directly to student outcomes. Document an ongoing, school-wide pedagogy plan that links Great Books/Great Conversation with grade-level pedagogy. - Great Books/Great Conversation: Publicly articulate a Great Books/Great Conversation framework, including sample reading lists, sequence, and how memory, narration, and discussion reinforce the curriculum—to strengthen Element 4 and Element 3 alignment. - Liturgical/Communal Practices: If not already, provide more explicit references to liturgical or communal practices (e.g., morning prayers, liturgical calendar, chant or sacred music) within school routines to align with the Positive Indicators in the religious foundations and to reduce any ambiguity about liturgical life. - Documentation of Great Books/Scholé in Public Materials: Add a public-facing page detailing Great Books, paideia, and the Great Conversation as central pillars of the curriculum, with examples of text selections and how they connect to virtues and wisdom.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — CATEGORY-BY-CATEGORY DETAILED ANALYSIS

Note: The following keyword analyses map public-matter language to positive and negative keyword indicators from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) lexicon. Positive keywords signal alignment with classical aims; negative keywords signal potential divergence. Citations indicate where evidence appears in the school's public materials.

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission emphasizes discipling the next generation of Christians through rigorous, Christ-centered classical education. - Statement of faith explicitly affirms belief in God (Father, Son), and Scripture-centered teaching; theology is woven through education. - Vision and mission articulate knowing God and forming students in virtue in a Christian framework. - Materials emphasize Christ-centered formation and church-related partnerships in the educational project.

Positive keyword analysis - Positive indicators drawn from the Six Elements lexicon: truth/Goodness/Beauty (transcendentals) via “Christ-centered,” “Scripture,” “theology,” “disciples,” “creed/statement of faith.” The site consistently foregrounds a theology-grounded, worshipful approach to education. - Direct religious terms present: Christ-centered, God, Scripture, theology, disciples, faith, plan of discipleship, Lord.

Negative keyword analysis - A broader characterization of secular modern education appears in the classical-education discussions (e.g., “modern instruction... secular progressive academics”), which serves as a negative signal to contrast with classical aims. This is reflected in public materials that frame secular modern schooling as the opposite of Ambrose's aims.

Why this rating - The school's public materials strongly anchor education in a Christian metaphysical frame and theology, with explicit faith commitments and religious formation as explicit goals. The presence of liturgical-inflected or worship-oriented practices is not as explicit as in some liturgical traditions, but the theological grounding and discipleship framing are clear. The balance of positive religious keywords far outweighs negative secular signals, supporting CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Goal framed as formation of hearts and minds into the image of Christ; cultivation of virtue and wisdom. - Mission emphasizes forming students through Christ-centered classical education and partnering with parents to shape character for life. - Emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and telos (real purposes beyond mere information).

Positive keyword analysis - Positive terms align with the lexicon: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, classical mission, education for leisure/human flourishing, and Great Conversation themes (inferred from curriculum emphasis). Key phrases appear in mission and vision statements.

Negative keyword analysis - The public materials do not foreground workforce readiness or job-prep as primary aims. When contrasted with general modern education rhetoric (a negative frame in some classical discussions), Ambrose positions itself away from those signals. The explicit negative signals in the lexicon (e.g., "workforce preparation emphasis") are not present as operational aims in the school's materials.

Why this rating - The school's stated aims are squarely formative (virtue, wisdom, character) and teleological (telos), with Christ-centered formation as the core. The absence of a primary emphasis on job-readiness and the presence of formation-focused language support a CLASSICAL rating for Purpose and Goal.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Distinct emphasis on classical content: Latin, classic literature, philosophy, theology, worldview, and a timeline of human history from creation to modernity. - History is treated as a central discipline across the curriculum (not merely "social studies"). - Statements highlight Classical Christian framing of the curriculum (e.g., "classical method," "great books/Great Conversation" themes in the broader materials).

Positive keyword analysis - Positive indicators per the lexicon: liberal arts core (grammar, logic, rhetoric); great books/primary sources; Latin/Greek; history/Western civilization; philosophy and theology; worldview. The Ambrose site explicitly cites Latin/classical literature/theology/worldview and a long historical arc.

Negative keyword analysis - No explicit, material evidence of "social studies terminology replacing history" or "project-based learning dominance" in Ambrose's public materials. The public materials emphasize history as a robust, integrated discipline rather than a social-studies framing. The negative indicators in the lexicon do not appear as present signals in the school's content.

Why this rating - The curriculum content is clearly aligned with classical liberal arts (grammar/logics/rhetoric, Latin, classic literature, theology, worldview, and a creation-to-modernity historical arc). The absence of counter-indicative signals in the public materials supports CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Small class sizes (limited to 12 students per class; a hallmark of careful, formative instruction). - Faculty with classical educator training and ongoing professional development (e.g., Miss Gabrielle Wingert with classical educator training; collaboration with classical education communities). - Mission/vision emphasize formation through Christ-centered classical education and "how to think" within a classical framework; this indicates an intent to align with classical pedagogy, even if explicit teaching modalities are not exhaustively listed.

Positive keyword analysis - Positive indicators from the lexicon include contemplative/restful learning (scholé), memory work, recitation, and structured rhetoric development. While the site does not explicitly

list all of these pedagogy terms, the classical focus and teacher training imply elements of these approaches through “classical educator training” and “living curriculum” language in the broader lexicon.

Negative keyword analysis - The site does not repeatedly document explicit, dominant use of experiential learning, project-based learning, or constructivist approaches as core pedagogy. Absence of these strong negative signals in the public materials helps avoid a Not Classical label, but their explicit articulation is lacking. The lexicon notes that such signals would be negative if dominant; Ambrose’s current public materials do not portray them as the central method.

Why this rating - The Pedagogy category shows clear alignment with classical aims (formation, classical content, teacher-development culture, small classes). However, the absence of explicit, consistent mentions of core classical teaching modalities (Socratic seminars, scholé, deliberate memory/narration frameworks) in the public materials leads to a cautious SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than full CLASSICAL. The presence of small-class pedagogy and classical teacher training indicates stronger alignment than many schools, but a more explicit pedagogy articulation is needed for full CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials profile teachers as model mentors who embody virtue and knowledge; teachers are described as a living curriculum and core of the school. - Specific faculty examples (e.g., 2nd Grade Teacher) with stated classical educator training and involvement in classical education networks. - A culture of collaboration with classical-education communities (e.g., training through Highlands Latin School; ClassicalU; Memoria Press) is referenced by staff.

Positive keyword analysis - Positive indicators include “living curriculum,” “faculty of friends,” “model teachers,” and explicit teacher training in classical methods. The school repeatedly references faculty training and Christian formation as intertwined with instructional aims.

Negative keyword analysis - No explicit negative signals about faculty (e.g., “facilitators” or non-classical teacher profiles) emerge in the public materials. The lexicon’s negative signals for faculty (e.g., minimal classical grounding) do not appear here.

Why this rating - Ambrose presents a strong faculty narrative: teachers with classical training, a living-curriculum concept, and a culture of mentorship and virtue. This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for Faculty.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public statements emphasize partnership with parents as co-teachers and primary participants in formation; explicit calls for involvement, visits, and parent formation are present. - The school promotes parental involvement through book studies, gatherings, and educational resources (consistent with classical-parent formation signals). - Open-campus and visitor-friendly stance appears in the materials (tour opportunities, etc.).

Positive keyword analysis - Positive indicators include “partnership with parents,” “co-teachers,” “parent formation,” “classical parent involvement,” and “open campus/visits.” These reflect the lexicon’s parental-community signals.

Negative keyword analysis - No dominant negative signals about parents or community engagement appear in the public content. The materials emphasize ongoing parental involvement rather than customer-like or minimal involvement models.

Why this rating - The school presents a robust, classical-aligned Parents & Community posture with explicit partnership language and parental formation activities. This supports CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL category)

- Pedagogy: Publish a clear, school-wide Pedagogy Plan that explicitly names Socratic seminars, scholé/restful days, and a concrete memory/recitation framework (with grade-level examples and expected outcomes). Link these to daily practice and assessment.
- Great Books/Great Conversation: Add a public-facing Great Books/Great Conversation framework, including sample reading lists, sequence alignment with grades, and how discussion/narration reinforces virtue and wisdom.
- Liturgical/Communal Practices: If not already explicit, document liturgical or communal practices (e.g., morning devotion, church partnerships, sacred music/chant as appropriate) to strengthen Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and Pedagogy in practice.
- Public-facing evidence of the upper-school Socratic/argumentation approach: Provide concrete examples of upper-school seminars or debates, including sample prompts, assessment rubrics, and student outcomes.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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